War for France

The period between the beginning of the war and the 10th of May 1940 was referred to as the 'phony war' in Britain, because the actual war still appeared to be far away. During this time, the young were transported to farmlands and rations were stored in preparation for war. The people experienced many night power outages and were forced to use gas lamps.

Belgium was being overpowered by the Germans and begged the Allies for help. The British and French responded by moving into Belgium to counter the German assault. Along the Franco-German fringe, the French had a weaker force. They instead placed confidence in the Maginot Line, which was a 280-mile long battle stronghold established in the mid-1930s to protect France against Germany. The Germans rendered it useless one morning in May 1940 when they evaded it by crossing north of the setup. They marched through the Ardennes timberland and surprised everyone because the French had considered the landscape to be too tough for the Germans to cross. On May 14, the Germans took the town of Sedan on the French side of the Ardennes. They did not stop to think about French resistance and pushed north towards the English Channel. The Allies were forced to regroup and rethink their strategy since they had expected the German forces to march towards Paris. During the First World War in 1916, the Germans were not able to take Verdun despite ten months of trench fighting. In May 1940, it took them only one day to conquer Verdun.

In Holland, Rotterdam was shelled profusely with no hope of winning. On May 15th, the Dutch finally surrendered in fear of further destruction. On May 28, Belgium also surrendered after seeing other nations fall one by one. The Allied Forces were caught with their backs to the ocean in the French waterfront town of Dunkirk. The Germans were ready to demolish the entire British Expeditionary Force but were mysteriously requested by Hitler to stop outside the town. Between May 26th and June 3rd, more than 1,000 military and nonmilitary vessels saved 338,226 soldiers by taking them back to Britain. The retreat occurred with a horrible frenzy and broken ranks. Officers shot some of their soldiers for losing restraint and not